

No placement commissions. No facility money. Ever.



## On the tour

**01 DINING**

- ☐ Visit during an actual mealtime — observe the food, the service, the atmosphere
- ☐ If someone needs help eating: where does it happen, & who provides it?
- ☐ How are medical diets handled — is there a real system in place?
- ☐ How do they assist residents who have trouble swallowing?
- ☐ How do staff notice and report a resident starting to have trouble swallowing?
- ☐ Who catches weight loss, and what happens when they do?
- ☐ Is a registered dietitian involved, and who flags residents for review?

**02 ENVIRONMENT**

- ☐ Look for fall hazards in the halls — lighting, handrails, floor transitions
- ☐ Check the areas off the tour route — and the smell
- ☐ See the real unit, not the model — spend your time in the bathroom
- ☐ Does the building still work as mobility declines?
- ☐ Building security — staffed entrance, after-hours entry, sign-in

**03 LOCATION & ACCESS**

- ☐ Will the people who matter actually visit this community?
- ☐ Transportation to appointments and outings — provided? a fee? a limit?
- ☐ Assess the neighborhood & proximity to current doctors and familiar places

**04 STAFFING**

- ☐ Staffing ratio — residents per aide, overnight/weekends, & the callout plan
- ☐ How fast do staff respond to a call for help?
- ☐ What clinical training is present on each shift? Overnight & weekend ceiling?
- ☐ Caregiver tenure — how many aides here were here a year ago?
- ☐ Are shifts filled by their own staff, or by agencies?
- ☐ Who runs clinical operations, what's their background, how long in the role?

**05 RESPONDING TO CHANGING NEEDS**

- ☐ Their emergency procedure — who assesses, ER threshold, & who calls you
- ☐ How does a routine, non-emergency clinical concern get escalated?
- ☐ Is any medical care delivered on site? (A plus, not a baseline.)
- ☐ Clinical partners — home health, therapy, hospice. Any in house?
- ☐ Review your loved one's documented needs with the care director
- ☐ Can they care for your loved one as needs rise — at what point can't they?
- ☐ How is the service plan created and kept current?

## On the tour

**06 MEDICATIONS**

- ☐ Who administers medications, and who do they call when something's unclear?
- ☐ How are medication changes tracked after a hospital stay or doctor visit?
- ☐ How are as-needed (PRN) medications decided and overseen?
- ☐ The pharmacy — its cost, whether you can use your own, and backup plan
- ☐ How often is the full medication list reviewed, and by whom?

**07 ACTIVITIES & ENGAGEMENT**

- ☐ Look past the calendar — what actually runs, and what gets cancelled?
- ☐ Does programming span real range, and include every ability level?
- ☐ What do staff do when a resident starts to withdraw?
- ☐ Do residents have a real say in what's offered?

**08 CULTURE & COMMUNICATION**

- ☐ Watch the unstaged moments — do staff knock and wait before entering?
- ☐ Speak with a resident, or a visiting family member, directly
- ☐ Speak with a caregiver without the marketing director present
- ☐ How do you raise concerns — and what's the ombudsman backstop?
- ☐ How does the community keep loved ones informed day to day?

**09 MEMORY CARE**

- ☐ How is the unit secured, and what happens when a resident wants to leave?
- ☐ How do staff respond to agitation — redirection, or medication first?
- ☐ What are residents actually doing — engaged, or parked?
- ☐ Is there a consistent daily structure? What does a typical day look like?
- ☐ Does the unit feel calming, or agitating?
- ☐ What dementia-specific training do staff receive? Have them name it.
- ☐ Can they care for your loved one through late-stage dementia?

**10 CONTRACTS & COST**

- ☐ Get the complete fee schedule in writing — what's included, what isn't
- ☐ How does the level-of-care assessment work? What does each step up cost?
- ☐ What does the move-in fee cover, and what's refundable?
- ☐ Rate-increase history and any caps — do the math several years out
- ☐ Does the community accept Medicaid, and what does that actually cover?
- ☐ Is there a long-term care insurance policy, and does it apply here?
- ☐ What would cause your loved one to be asked to leave? Get it in writing.
- ☐ What happens to the room, and the bill, if your loved one is hospitalized?